Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Anne E. Dote

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS

Anne E. Dote

Director of Education & Docent Programs

Anne can make a school group care about a pot shard. Tonight's donors are proving harder.

• Coaches **Reed DeLabel** through gallery tours. **Reed** keeps adding footnotes to the children's handouts.

• Turns **Claire O'Scuro**'s research into tours people can follow. **Claire** keeps restoring the difficult words.

• Invites **Justin Tyme** to speak about Tulsa history. She now reviews his slides before inviting donors.

ACTING TIPS

Engaging, practical, empathetic, irreverent about institutional pomp.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Anne E. Dote. I run education here. I can make almost anything interesting, including a room full of adults behaving badly.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Anne E. Dote

Behind the portrait

Your stake tonight

Broke a promise to a school group once before and cannot bear being the adult who disappoints them again.

During the investigation

Keep your account private until each round. Your printed answers establish what happened. You can react in your own style, but do not invent a new event, witness, or alibi.

Conversations to start

- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page.
- Keep your private branch readings for their announced rounds.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Anne E. Dote

The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *The mirror has a secret that never appears in its reflection. Look above the glass.*

2 *The artwork is innocent; something behind it deserves questioning.*

3 *A Bible contains a small addition that is not part of scripture.*

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Anne E. Dote

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I'd promised the school places before the grant was approved. Grant wanted their tour replaced by a patron preview. I put the school program back in the handout. He asked who authorized it. Fair question. I've stood in front of children before and told them a visit was canceled. I wasn't doing it again while a donor explained how generous he was being.

IF MURDERER

I'd promised school places before the grant was approved. Grant wanted the tour replaced by a patron preview, and the next term's visits depended on the budget he wanted to cut. I put our program back. He asked whose permission I used. Nobody's. Scraping together money for one visit wouldn't keep the next bus coming. I've told children a promised visit was canceled before. He could make me stand in front of them and do it again.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Anne E. Dote

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I replaced the education handout and led the short tour to Frank's closed alcove. Turned them around. Reed's footnotes stayed; Grant's language went. My version admitted the school visit still needed money. I was making my promise the museum's problem in public. Claire, I know that wasn't an approved plan. Neither was turning every ordinary visit into a privilege someone wealthy had to grant us.

IF MURDERER

I replaced the education handout and led the short tour. Frank got an earful over the closed alcove. I also took the handout to Grant's private place during the reception. His glass was waiting. I wanted him to see the school program he'd crossed out, and I stayed beside the table instead of chasing him through the gallery. Claire, I know the gala route wasn't mine to change. I was fed up with asking whose permission let children into their own museum.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Anne E. Dote

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

We turned from the closed alcove to the public cases. We didn't enter Grant's private room. The assistant docent was with us. Workshop money will fund the school places; the paid weekend session is canceled. I can already hear the people whose session I've taken away. Nobody gets to tell the children the donor saved their visit. He didn't. I made another choice somebody will hate.

IF MURDERER

The tour went through Grant's private room. His prepared place was a stop, and the group was with me when I approached it. That was my only visit. The closure changed the entrance, not our whole route. I had people following me. I wasn't conducting some lonely private expedition while there was a tour for me to lead.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Anne E. Dote

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume

Anne E. Dote

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. The marked route and assistant docent place our turnback at the public cases. The private room was no tour stop. I used workshop money for a school promise I had no authority to make. The displaced guests deserve their explanation. I will give it. I would rather have them angry at me than teach the children that somebody else always decides whether they belong here.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The approved tour did not include his private room. I used poison from the preview bottle at his unattended place, without my tour group. I later put that visit inside the tour in my account. The marked route excludes the room, and the assistant docent recorded the actual turnback to the public cases. I borrowed a group that had never been beside that glass. Funding the school places did not erase the promise Grant could expose. I promised children a place in this museum. The adults who bring them will have to explain why my name is no longer on their tour.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.